

Stop Female Cat Spraying — Action Checklist

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RULE OUT MEDICAL CAUSES

- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Observe your cat's urination posture and spray location to confirm she's spraying on vertical surfaces with her tail-up rather than squatting to urinate on floors, which would indicate house soiling instead.
- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Request a urinalysis and urine culture from your vet to rule out urinary tract infection and hidden bacterial infection before assuming the problem is purely behavioral.
- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Ask your vet to check for arthritis or joint pain during the physical exam, since pain while climbing into the litter box can trigger spraying in older cats.
- ☐ **Rule Out Medical Causes:** Seek emergency veterinary care immediately if your cat is straining to urinate with little or no urine production, crying during urination, or showing blood in her urine.

OPTIMIZE LITTER BOX SETUP

- ☐ **Optimize Litter Box Setup:** Apply the n+1 rule by providing one litter box per cat plus one additional box, placing them in different locations throughout your home rather than side by side.
- ☐ **Optimize Litter Box Setup:** Replace standard litter pans with large plastic storage bins that give your cat more room to maneuver and posture properly when spraying or eliminating.
- ☐ **Optimize Litter Box Setup:** Position litter boxes in quiet, low-traffic areas away from loud appliances and other stressors to make your cat feel safe enough to use them consistently.
- ☐ **Optimize Litter Box Setup:** Give any litter type or box change a minimum 4-week trial before deciding whether it worked, since cats need significant time to adjust to new arrangements.

REDUCE ENVIRONMENTAL STRESS

- ☐ **Reduce Environmental Stress:** Make a list of potential stress triggers in your home including new household members, moved furniture, new neighborhood cats, construction noise, or recent disruptions to your cat's routine.

 - ☐ **Reduce Environmental Stress:** Provide adequate resources for each cat in your home including one perch, one hiding spot, and one feeding station to prevent resource competition that drives spraying.

 - ☐ **Reduce Environmental Stress:** Plug in Feliway or similar pheromone diffusers in rooms where spraying occurs to create a calming environment that reduces your cat's baseline stress level.

 - ☐ **Reduce Environmental Stress:** Scoop litter boxes daily and completely change the litter weekly to maintain a clean environment from your cat's perspective, since cats avoid boxes that smell dirty to them.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.